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**GLOBAL
RANKINGS PLACE
GREAT EMPHASIS
ON PUBLICATIONS
IN GLOBALLY
RECOGNISED
JOURNALS
AND HOW A
SCHOOL SHAPES
MANAGEMENT
THINKING**

TOWARDS GLOBAL RANKINGS

Indian B-schools are thriving in career and alumni outcomes but research and thought leadership remain critical to make a global mark

OVER THE YEARS, Indian B-schools have produced CEOs of global organisations, transformed numerous sectors, and attracted some of the most impactful minds. Yet, when global rankings were announced each year, only a small number made the cut. The winds, however, are shifting, and Indian schools are finally carving out a niche in what is undoubtedly a very competitive field.

It's heartening to see many Indian schools breaking into global rankings such as the Financial Times (FT) and Quacquarelli Symonds (QS). These schools have been slowly but surely changing the long-held view that we do well in the region, but struggle on the global stage because of ranking criteria, structural issues and perception gaps.

Eight Indian schools feature in the FT Global MBA Rankings for 2025. A total of 14 Indian schools were recognised in the QS Global MBA Rankings for 2026. In 2025, 11 Indian schools were recognised in the FT Masters in Management (MiM) Rankings. An overall analysis highlights possible reasons for a stronger performance from schools in the last few years. These include stronger alumni outcomes, value-for-money orientation, consistently high place-

ment results, growing research and academic output, amongst others.

A deeper dive into school-level data for the FT Global MBA Rankings for 2025 brings out important learnings. Salary percentage increase, alumni network, career progress, employment rates, gender diversity (w.r.t. students), and value for money are parameters that stand out for the Indian schools ranked in the top 100 this year.

Learnings From Successes

As an example, Indian School of Business (ISB, with an overall rank of 27 in 2025, is ranked 2nd on the Pre-MBA to Post-MBA salary increase for its graduates. Equally impressive is the graduate salary jump for both XLRI (~249%) and IIM Kozhikode (~242%). Interestingly, with an overall rank of 31, IIM Ahmedabad was ranked 1st for Career Progress.

This parameter measures the advancement achieved by alumni in terms of seniority and the size of the companies they work for three years after graduating. XLRI with an overall ranking of 83, was ranked 24th for Career Progress. Data suggests that top schools are playing on the front foot when it comes to alumni- and career-related graduate outcomes.

The picture changes when it